wrote, is "the natural and abiding ally of anti-Semitism and its most powerful justification"—a standpoint shared by his closest liberal Jewish ally, Claude Montefiore.[8]

The Jewish anti-Zionist critique from the Left espoused a similar view long before the Shoah or the creation of Israel. Like the liberal assimilationists, Jewish Marxists invariably perceived Zionism as a nationlist irritant, a harmful diversion from the class struggle and the historically inevitable process of assimilation into modern society.

In Marxist ideology there was simply no justification for the existence of a separate "Jewish nation," as the Jewish socialist Bund in Russia and Poland discovered to its cost. Although Bundists from the outset had trashed Zionism as a "petty-bourgeois utopia," they, too, found themselves severely castigated by internationalist Jews such as Leon Trotsky, Otto Bauer, Julius Martov, or Rosa Luxemburg for their intolerably particularist Yiddish-oriented nationalism.[9]

In the United States, Jewish anti-Zionism was no less powerful before 1945 than its German, Austrian, British, or French counterparts. The founder of the Central Conference of American Rabbis, the charismatic Isaac Mayer Wise (1819–1900) emphatically rejected Zionism as a European-style nationalism based on race, blood, and territory.[10] An indefatigable liberal optimist, Wise believed the 20th century would see the end of all anti-Jewish persecution, even in Russia. He declared Zionism to be "alien" to American Jews, calling it "a *fata morgana*, a momentary inebriation of morbid minds, and a prostitution of Israel's holy cause to a madman's dance of unsound politicians.[11] His disciples, especially in the Reform movement, the American Jewish Committee, and the still-dominant German-Jewish establishment in the United States, firmly believed in the future of the Diaspora rather than Palestine; in Judaism, not Jewish secular nationalism. The United States was Zion. The American melting-pot had no place for "ghettoism, reactionist romanticism, or 'separatist' neo-nationalism" as one leading American Reform rabbi, David Philipson, bluntly put it a century ago.[12]

In the 1930s, such militant anti-Zionist views were gradually modified inside the Reform movement. Rising American antisemitism in the late 1930s, the draconian restrictions on Jewish immigration and the growing isolationism in the United States nonetheless intensified the anti-Zionism within the AJC, which continued into 1947 and was encouraged by the U.S. State Department. After 1948, however, this institutional Jewish anti-Zionism did begin to weaken, except within the American Council for Judaism—which continued to sharply condemn Zionism as a danger to the status of American Jews. For the Council, there was never any question of recognizing

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